Sometimes, children hesitate to speak up because of a sense of **loyalty**. Will complaining to an adult about peers who are bullying get them into trouble? For example, if Meena were to tell their teacher about what Ajay does to Anu, would it be wrong? Meena may feel that she will lose Ajay's friendship but she will feel better by doing the right thing of standing up for Anu. It's important to learn to distinguish between situations which require intervention and those that don't. And remember, she will also be helping Ajay! It is not healthy growing up being a bully and Ajay, too, needs help.

Many schools and colleges and even work places have strict rules to prevent bullying but it can still happen. If you notice it taking place around you, make sure you report it so it is stopped. You would have then contributed to a safer and more peaceful world.

This story is by Tulir - Centre for the Prevention and Healing of Child Sexual Abuse, Chennai.

GLOSSARY		
bullying	-	teasing others
humiliate	-	make others feel ashamed
consequences	-	result or effect
peer pressure	-	influence from members of the same group
dejected	-	sad and depressed
nightmares	-	frightening dreams
empathy	-	understand and share other's feelings
loyalty	-	strong support or being loyal



A. Choose the correct answer.

1. What is bullying?
   a) When you and a friend get into a fight.
   b) When someone accidently bumps into you on the playground.
   c) When someone is hurt by others either by words or actions, feels bad because of it, and finds it hard to stop what's happening to them.
   d) Rolling a ball to knock over pins.

2. What should you do if you are being bullied?
   a) Speak up.
   b) Tell an adult.
   c) Know that you have the right to be safe.
   d) All of the above.

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